

Why is everyone so obsessed with Ai when it is so bad for the environment and seems frivolous?

Posted by u/Knitspin • 0 points • 30 comments

Is this just another craze that everyone feels like they have to get on before they get left behind? What do companies think that it's going to do for them? So many people also think it's dangerous.

Comments

u/Clackers2020 • 1 points • 2024-09-17 09:09 UTC

>Is this just another craze that everyone feels like they have to get on before they get left behind?

No it is not. Smartphones and the internet were also treated the same way. Stupidly hyped and thrown into everything regardless of whether it made sense to do so. In the next few years AI will improve and will stay in areas where it helps. It will fall out of fashion in stupid places.

u/capnwally14 • -1 points • 2024-09-16 23:53 UTC

Here's a good example based on Chat GPT's latest o1:

[<https://mathstodon.xyz/@tao/113132502735585408>]

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Note that Terrence Tao is (considered by many) the greatest living mathematician. Assume that its like overhyped in the short term, but vastly underhyped over the medium-long term - if reading that post doesn't make you feel it, let me try and elucidate further:

We are quickly approaching a world, where multistep long term reasoning can be fully outsourced to AIs. This fundamentally means that with a combination of three things (sufficient GPU compute + energy + data) we can meaningfully replace knowledge workers.

This will be a seismic shift for society - and it isnt a matter of individual countries, we're talking about at a nation state level things may massively shift. MENA nations that are energy and cash rich, but population poor - can invest in data centers + chips to advance their own technology (without relying on humans in Silicon Valley). This is an arms race, whether people recognize it or not.

The first jobs that will be automated in this way are AI engineers - and the rate of progress will be rate limited by hardware, data, and energy. Again, take my word or not - but this interview is the best summary I've had and I use it to intro other folks: [<https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zdbVtZln9IM>]

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Couple that with this other basket of issues - much of our world relies on social interactions (or assumptions about ability to detect "humanness"). This is a fundamentally bad assumption in a world of realistic fakes / substitutes. Many people who have talked about building a verifiable web have been talking about this for the last decade - but we have a ways to go to build all this out properly.

u/grayscale001 • 0 points • 2024-09-16 22:34 UTC

Bad for the environment?

u/sd_saved_me555 • -1 points • 2024-09-16 22:31 UTC

AI has a ton of potential and absolutely has its place in industry. I'll grant you that the average person's expectations of it are probably more grand than what it is in reality, but I already use it as a viable tool that reduces the amount of grunt work I have to do.

u/baifengjiu • 1 points • 2024-09-16 22:19 UTC

Bc it's not used for good but instead by dumb bitches who think they can make art without putting hard work.